

Lecture: Letter to the Editor (Expository Writing)

1. What is a Letter to the Editor?

A Letter to the Editor is a formal piece of writing sent to a newspaper or magazine to:

Express an opinion

Raise awareness about an issue

Suggest a solution

Inform the public

2. It is part of expository writing because it:

Explains a problem clearly

Presents facts and reasons

Maintains a logical and organized structure

3. Purpose of a Letter to the Editor

A letter to the editor is written to:

Inform people about an issue

Explain a problem clearly

Persuade authorities or the public

Suggest possible solutions

Example topics:

Pollution

Traffic problems

Education issues

Social media effects

4. Tone and Style

Since it is expository writing, the tone should be:

Clear

Formal

Objective (not too emotional)

Logical

5. Avoid:

Slang

Personal attacks

Over-emotional language

Complete Format (VERY IMPORTANT)

Students must follow this format in exams:

1. Sender's Address (Writer's Address)

Write your address at the top (left side)

Example:

House No. 12, Street 5
Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi

2. Date

Example:

April 4, 2026

3. Editor's Address

The Editor
Dawn Newspaper
Karachi

4. Subject Line

Short and clear

Example:

Subject: Poor Sanitation in Our Area

5. Salutation

Sir/Madam,

6. Introduction (Paragraph 1)

State the purpose

Mention the issue

Example:

I am writing to draw your attention to the poor sanitation conditions in our area.

7. Body (Paragraph 2–3)

Explain the problem

Give reasons

Add examples

Example:

Garbage is not collected regularly, and streets remain dirty. This causes bad smells and spreads diseases. Residents are facing serious health problems.

8. Conclusion (Final Paragraph)

Suggest solution

Request action

Example:

I request the concerned authorities to take immediate action and improve sanitation services.

9. Closing

Yours sincerely,

Ali Khan

Complete Example Letter 1 (FULL FORMAT)

House No. 45, Block A
North Nazimabad, Karachi

April 4, 2026

The Editor

Dawn Newspaper

Karachi

Subject: Increasing Traffic Problems in the City

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to highlight the growing traffic problems in our city. The number of vehicles is increasing day by day, causing serious congestion.

Due to traffic jams, people arrive late to work and students face difficulties in reaching school.

Moreover, pollution is also increasing because of excessive vehicles.

I request the authorities to improve traffic management and introduce strict rules to control this issue.

Yours sincerely,

Ahmed

Example 2: Pollution Problem

House No. 12, Street 4
Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi

April 4, 2026

The Editor

Dawn Newspaper

Karachi

Subject: Rising Pollution in the City

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to draw your attention to the increasing pollution in our city. The environment is becoming unhealthy day by day.

Smoke from vehicles and factories is polluting the air. Garbage is also not properly managed, which creates bad smells and diseases. People, especially children and elderly, are suffering from health problems.

I request the concerned authorities to take strict action to control pollution and ensure a clean environment.

Yours sincerely,

Ali

Example 3: Poor Road Conditions

House No. 45, Block B
North Nazimabad, Karachi

April 4, 2026

The Editor
The News International
Karachi
Subject: Poor Condition of Roads

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to highlight the poor condition of roads in our area. The roads are broken and full of potholes.

Due to this problem, traffic jams are common and accidents are increasing. During rain, the roads become muddy and difficult to use. People face daily inconvenience while traveling.

I request the authorities to repair the roads as soon as possible for the safety of the public.

Yours sincerely,

Ahmed

Example 4: Load Shedding

House No. 78, Street 2

Korangi, Karachi

April 4, 2026

The Editor

Express Tribune

Karachi

Subject: Frequent Load Shedding in Our Area

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to complain about the frequent load shedding in our area. Electricity cuts happen many times a day.

This problem affects students, workers, and businesses. Students cannot study properly, and businesses suffer losses. In hot weather, it becomes very difficult for people to live without electricity.

I request the authorities to solve this issue and ensure a regular supply of electricity.

Yours sincerely,

Sara

Example 5: Lack of Cleanliness

House No. 9, Street 10

Liaquatabad, Karachi

April 4, 2026

The Editor

Dawn Newspaper

Karachi

Subject: Lack of Cleanliness in Public Areas

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to bring attention to the lack of cleanliness in public places. Streets and parks are full of garbage.

This situation creates an unhealthy environment and spreads diseases. People are also not aware of the importance of cleanliness.

I request the authorities to improve cleaning services and educate people about hygiene.

Yours sincerely,

Sara